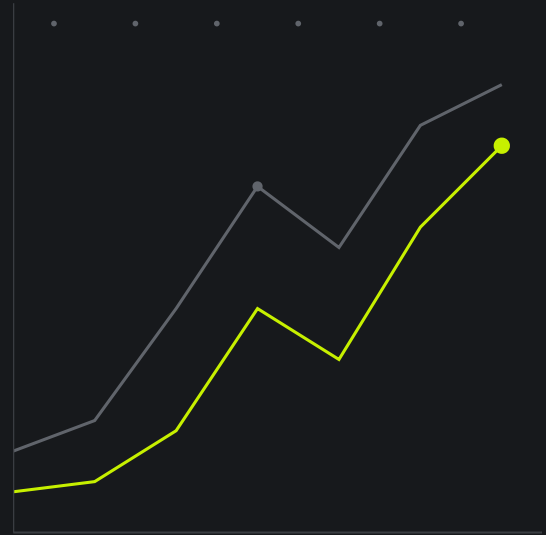


# GOOGLE ADS AUDIT

E-commerce Beauty Brand  
Search + Demand Generation



Illustrative performance curve — conceptual, not an actual account chart.

PORTFOLIO SIMULATION  
2026

This is an educational portfolio simulation based on publicly available audit material. The account was not managed by the portfolio author, and no results are claimed as personally generated.

## 01 / DIAGNOSE

# Executive Summary

Establishing the account's performance baseline.

A structured audit of a Search and Demand Generation account for an e-commerce hair-coloring shampoo brand, built to demonstrate how a junior performance marketer diagnoses efficiency before recommending scale.

## Business Context

The brand sells a 10-minute, ammonia-free, 5-in-1 hair-coloring shampoo across three shades and two sizes, marketed in Pakistan via Google Ads, Meta, and TikTok.

SOURCE OBSERVATION

## Audit Objective

Evaluate account structure, budget efficiency, targeting, and measurement quality across Search and Demand Generation before any recommendation to increase spend.

STRATEGIC FRAMING

## Key Findings

- Search shows a substantially lower observed CPA than Demand Generation.
- Demand Generation is running on Target CPA bidding without clear evidence that the target reflects account profitability.
- Location and audience performance vary widely, with some segments generating high-cost, low-yield clicks.
- A destination/landing-page issue and asset disapprovals were identified as technical risks.

## Biggest Opportunities vs. Biggest Risks

- Opportunity:** Reallocating incremental budget toward validated high-efficiency Search and audience segments.
- Opportunity:** Cleaning search terms and negatives to reduce wasted spend.
- Risk:** Scaling spend before tracking and destination issues are resolved.
- Risk:** Treating Quality Score or CPA in isolation from conversion value.

## SO WHAT?

The account is not short of demand — it is short of validated efficiency signals. The strategic recommendation is to fix measurement and targeting gaps before increasing budget, rather than scaling on top of unresolved issues.

# Business & Product Context

What is being sold, to whom, and through which channels.

## Product

A 10-minute, shampoo-based hair-coloring product positioned as 5-in-1 and ammonia-free, with mess-free application. Available in three shades — Black, Dark Brown, Light Brown — and two sizes, 200ml and 400ml.

SOURCE OBSERVATION

## Customer Proposition

Convenience-led positioning (10-minute application, mess-free) combined with a safety claim (ammonia-free) and social proof through celebrity endorsements, positive reviews, and bundle offers.

SOURCE OBSERVATION

## Key Differentiators

- Speed of use relative to conventional hair coloring.
- Ammonia-free formulation claim.
- 5-in-1 multi-benefit positioning.
- Celebrity endorsement and review-driven trust signals.
- Bundle offers supporting average-order-value growth.

## Marketing Channels

Google Ads (Search, Demand Generation), Meta, and TikTok. Google Ads Search and Demand Generation are the focus of this audit.

SOURCE OBSERVATION

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## Audit Objectives

The audit evaluates the account across ten dimensions before forming a view on scaling readiness:

- |                       |                            |                          |
|-----------------------|----------------------------|--------------------------|
| —Account structure    | —Targeting & search intent | —Creative / ad assets    |
| —Campaign performance | —Audience performance      | —Landing page & tracking |
| —Budget efficiency    | —Geographic performance    | —Scaling readiness       |

### SO WHAT?

A strong product story does not guarantee efficient acquisition. The audit exists to separate a compelling proposition from a proven, measurable growth engine.

# Performance Snapshot

Source-derived / approximate figures. Months as referenced in source material; not a continuous fiscal sequence.

| MONTH    | SPEND (PKR) | CONVERSIONS | CPA (PKR) |
|----------|-------------|-------------|-----------|
| December | ~765K       | ~1.24K      | ~616      |
| February | ~2.52M      | ~1.55K      | ~1,600    |
| March    | ~2.7M       | ~2.51K      | ~1,100    |
| April    | ~1.5M       | ~1.52K      | ~758      |
| November | ~1.6M       | ~1.7K       | ~903      |

All figures are approximate and sourced from the audit transcript. Revenue, ROAS, CTR, CPC, and conversion-rate figures are data not available in source material and are not estimated here.

## CPA Trend (PKR)



Highlighted bar marks the highest observed monthly CPA in the source data.

## Spend Trend (PKR)



Spend and CPA do not move in a consistent proportional pattern month to month.

**PKR 160**

Observed Search CPA

SOURCE OBSERVATION

**PKR 1,747**

Observed Demand Gen CPA

SOURCE OBSERVATION

**~10.9×**

Illustrative CPA difference

CALCULATED FROM SOURCE-OBSERVED CPA FIGURES

## Reading the Data

The five reference months are not presented as a continuous fiscal sequence — December, February, March, April, and November appear in the source material without a confirmed year-over-year order.

ASSUMPTION / HYPOTHESIS

They are treated here as independent snapshots rather than a single trend line, since interpolating the missing months would overstate what the source actually supports.

## What the Snapshot Does Not Show

Spend and CPA move independently across the five months, which suggests CPA is being influenced by factors beyond budget level alone — targeting quality, seasonality, or competitive pressure are plausible contributors, but none are confirmed by the source.

ANALYTICAL INTERPRETATION

CAMPAIGN 01

# Search

High-intent demand capture; strongest observed efficiency in the account.

## Current Observation

Search recorded an observed CPA of approximately PKR 160, making it the strongest-performing campaign in the account on a cost-per-acquisition basis. SOURCE OBSERVATION

## Strengths

- Captures high-intent, bottom-funnel demand from users actively searching for the product or category.
- Uses a combination of exact and phrase match keywords.
- Negative keywords are already in place, reducing some irrelevant spend.
- Ad assets (sitelinks, callouts, structured snippets) are configured.

## Issues

- Search-term analysis has not been systematically used to expand negatives or promote converting queries.
- Competitor-brand search terms are appearing in query traffic without a defined inclusion/exclusion policy.
- Quality Score, Auction Insights, device, and location performance have not been reviewed on a recurring cadence.

## Risks

- Efficiency at current spend levels may not hold if budget is scaled without expanding keyword coverage carefully.
- Reported CPA does not confirm conversion value or profitability, only acquisition cost.

|             |                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OBSERVATION | Search shows the lowest observed CPA of any reviewed campaign.                                                                                             |
| IMPLICATION | Search is the most defensible channel to prioritize for incremental budget, subject to conversion-value validation.                                        |
| ACTION      | Run a structured search-term review, formalize a competitor-term policy, and expand well-performing exact-match themes before increasing budget elsewhere. |
| MEASUREMENT | CPA, conversion value (where available), impression share, and Quality Score trend over a minimum 2–4 week window.                                         |

CAMPAIGN 02

# Demand Generation

Upper/mid-funnel demand creation; highest observed acquisition cost in the account.

## Current Observation

Demand Generation recorded an observed CPA of approximately PKR 1,747, using Target CPA bidding. SOURCE OBSERVATION

## Strengths

- Reaches users earlier in the funnel than Search, supporting category and brand demand creation.
- Visually driven format suits a product with strong before/after and lifestyle imagery.

## Issues

- Observed CPA is substantially higher than Search on the same account.
- Certain audience segments show very high acquisition cost. SOURCE OBSERVATION
- Target CPA bidding is in use without confirmed evidence that the target reflects actual contribution margin.

## Risks

- Lowering Target CPA purely because a historical figure was lower risks starving the campaign of volume without evidence it improves profitability.
- Comparing Demand Gen and Search on CPA alone ignores differences in funnel stage and conversion quality.

|             |                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| OBSERVATION | Demand Gen CPA is substantially higher than observed Search CPA, and at least one audience segment is materially inflating acquisition cost.                                                             |
| IMPLICATION | Budget efficiency may be constrained by lower-intent or inefficient audience segments rather than the channel itself.                                                                                    |
| ACTION      | Segment audience-level performance, pause or reduce the least efficient segments, and evaluate Target CPA against conversion volume, quality, AOV, and margin — not against the historical number alone. |
| MEASUREMENT | CPA, conversion value, ROAS (where available), and conversion quality by audience segment.                                                                                                               |

### SO WHAT?

A higher CPA does not automatically mean a campaign should be cut. It means the segment-level data needs to be reviewed before a budget decision is made — the diagnosis has to happen at the audience level, not the campaign level.

# Audience Analysis

Demand Generation audience segments showed material spread in acquisition cost.

The source identified inefficient audience segments within Demand Generation, including hair-care-related segments with extremely high CPA. SOURCE OBSERVATION Specific

segment names and per-segment spend figures were not itemized in the source material.

DATA NOT AVAILABLE IN SOURCE MATERIAL

## Audience Optimization Framework

| TIER           | DEFINITION                                                                                   | RECOMMENDED ACTION                                                                   |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Scale          | Segments with validated efficient CPA and sufficient conversion volume to draw a conclusion. | Increase budget incrementally; monitor for CPA drift.                                |
| Monitor        | Segments performing near account average, or with volume too low to be conclusive.           | Hold budget; continue collecting data before acting.                                 |
| Reduce         | Segments with consistently elevated CPA across a sufficient sample.                          | Reduce budget share; retest at lower spend before excluding entirely.                |
| Exclude / Test | Segments showing sustained inefficiency with no signal of improving conversion quality.      | Exclude, or run a controlled test with a capped budget and defined success criteria. |

### Why Not Cut Immediately

A single elevated-CPA reading does not distinguish between a genuinely inefficient segment and one still in an early learning phase under Target CPA bidding. Reducing budget prematurely can reset that learning process and produce a worse signal than doing nothing.

ANALYTICAL INTERPRETATION

### Minimum Evidence Before Acting

A defensible tiering decision requires a consistent CPA pattern across a defined minimum conversion volume, observed over more than one reporting period — not a single week or a single spend spike.

STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATION

### SO WHAT?

The instinct to cut the "expensive" audience is reasonable, but not automatic. Without conversion-quality and volume context, cutting a segment on CPA alone risks removing a segment that is simply earlier in its learning phase. No specific segment-level figures are fabricated here — this framework is designed to be applied once real segment data is available.

# Geographic Analysis

Substantial variation between Pakistani cities was identified in the source material.

Some locations generated stronger conversion performance, some generated expensive clicks or conversions, and some generated clicks with no conversions at all.

**SOURCE OBSERVATION** Specific city names and volumes were not itemized in the source.

DATA NOT AVAILABLE IN SOURCE MATERIAL

## Location Optimization Framework

| TIER          | PROFILE                                                                        | RECOMMENDED ACTION                                                           |
|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Tier 1</b> | High-performing locations with efficient CPA and sufficient conversion volume. | Prioritize budget; consider location-specific bid adjustments.               |
| <b>Tier 2</b> | Acceptable performance, near account average.                                  | Monitor; no immediate change.                                                |
| <b>Tier 3</b> | High-cost locations with conversions, but at inefficient CPA.                  | Reduce bid adjustment or budget share; retest.                               |
| <b>Tier 4</b> | Low-quality or zero-conversion locations.                                      | Investigate sample size before excluding; exclude only with sufficient data. |

### Defining "Sufficient Data"

A practical starting threshold is a minimum spend or click volume per location before it is eligible for tiering at all — locations below the threshold stay in an "insufficient data" holding group rather than being scored.

STRATEGIC RECOMMENDATION

### Interaction With Budget Caps

In a market with many cities and a modest total budget, some locations may simply never reach a conclusive sample at current spend levels — that is itself a useful finding for future budget planning.

ANALYTICAL INTERPRETATION

### SO WHAT?

A location with zero conversions is not automatically a bad location — it may simply have too little data yet. Excluding it prematurely can remove a market that would have converted with more volume. Statistical significance should govern the decision, not the presence of a zero.

# Search-Term & Keyword Analysis

Match types, query mining, and negative-keyword discipline.

## Observations

—Exact and phrase match keywords are in use.

SOURCE OBSERVATION

—Negative keywords are present but were identified as an area for improvement.

SOURCE OBSERVATION

—Competitor-related search terms were observed in query traffic.

SOURCE OBSERVATION

—Systematic search-term mining was identified as an unrealized opportunity.

SOURCE OBSERVATION

## Weekly Workflow

1. Review search terms against active keyword themes.
2. Identify irrelevant or low-intent queries.
3. Add negative keywords at the appropriate level.
4. Identify high-intent, converting queries.
5. Promote valuable queries into dedicated keyword structures.
6. Review competitor-brand searches separately from category searches.
7. Monitor match-type behavior for drift over time.

### SO WHAT?

Search-term hygiene is the lowest-cost, highest-leverage lever available before scaling. It directly reduces wasted spend without requiring any change to bidding strategy or budget.

# Ad & Asset Audit

Sitelinks, callouts, structured snippets, promotions, and business assets.

## Assets in Use

- Sitelinks
- Callouts
- Structured snippets
- Promotion assets
- Business information / logo assets

Source observation.

## Issues Identified

- Blurry business logo asset.
- Business logo asset with inappropriate blank space.
- Additional asset-level disapprovals present in the account. SOURCE OBSERVATION

## Remediation Process

1. Identify the disapproved asset.
2. Check the specific policy reason listed by Google Ads.
3. Correct the asset to resolve the underlying issue.
4. Replace the asset, or submit an appeal where the disapproval appears incorrect.
5. Recheck approval status after resubmission.
6. Remove obsolete or redundant assets that are no longer relevant.

### SO WHAT?

Disapproved or low-quality assets reduce ad strength and eligibility for certain ad formats. This is a fast, low-cost fix that should be resolved before any budget increase, since it affects every impression served.

# Landing Page / CRO Audit

Conversion-rate-optimization hypotheses, not confirmed outcomes.

## Strengths

- Strong hero product image.
- Clear product presentation.
- Product size and shade selection.
- Reviews and social proof present.
- Celebrity endorsements featured.
- Bundle options available.

Source observation.

## CRO Hypotheses to Test

- Stronger CTA visual hierarchy.
- Better mobile-first presentation.
- Clearer product benefits above the fold.
- A/B testing of CTA design and placement.
- Genuine urgency or limited-stock messaging, only where factually accurate.
- A discount or email-capture mechanism for non-converting visitors.
- Review of any unsupported "No. 1" claim to ensure supporting evidence exists.

**HYPOTHESIS** — none of these changes are guaranteed to increase conversions; each should be tested.

## Checkout & Mobile UX

Checkout flow and mobile-loading performance were not itemized with specific metrics in the source material. **DATA NOT AVAILABLE IN SOURCE MATERIAL** These should be validated

directly as part of the technical QA pass described on the following page, since checkout friction can offset any gain from upstream CRO changes.

## How Hypotheses Should Be Tested

Each hypothesis should be tested individually where possible, with a clear success metric (conversion rate, add-to-cart rate, or bounce rate) defined before the test begins, rather than changing multiple elements at once.

## Sequencing With Paid Traffic

CRO testing is most conclusive once paid traffic quality is already stable — running CRO tests on top of unresolved targeting or tracking issues makes it harder to isolate what actually drove a change in conversion rate.

### SO WHAT?

None of these CRO changes are presented as guaranteed wins. The value of this section is the testing discipline — a ranked list of hypotheses with a defined way to measure each one, not a promise of a specific conversion-rate lift.

# Conversion Tracking & Measurement

Tracking must be validated before scaling.

**TRACKING**

→

DATA QUALITY

→

ATTRIBUTION

→

BUSINESS KPIS

→

OPTIMIZATION

## Audit Checklist

- Purchase conversion action configured and firing correctly.
- Conversion value passed accurately, including currency.
- Primary vs. secondary conversion actions clearly separated.
- GA4 and Google Ads integration reconciled.
- Enhanced conversions implemented where appropriate.

## Risks to Rule Out

- Duplicate conversion counting across tags or platforms.
- Attribution model mismatch between reporting sources.
- Transaction value or currency mismatches distorting CPA and ROAS.
- Conversion actions marked primary when they should be secondary (or vice versa).

### SO WHAT?

Every optimization decision in this audit — audience tiering, location tiering, Target CPA evaluation — depends on the conversion data being accurate. Tracking validation is treated as a P0 prerequisite, not a parallel workstream.

# Technical & Policy Issues

A destination-not-working issue was identified as a high-priority technical risk.

SOURCE OBSERVATION

## Destination QA Checklist

- Final URL resolves correctly.
- HTTPS is enforced.
- Redirects behave as expected.
- Mobile loading performance.
- Page accessibility.
- Product page functions correctly.
- Checkout flow completes end to end.
- Tracking parameters pass through cleanly.
- No broken links in the conversion path.
- Tracking continuity from click to conversion.

## Invalid Traffic / Click Quality

IP exclusions and click fraud were discussed in the source material. SOURCE OBSERVATION IP

exclusions alone do not resolve click fraud; a broader traffic-quality review is required.

- Google Ads invalid-traffic signals.
- Analytics behavioral patterns.
- Session recordings (e.g. Microsoft Clarity).
- Server-side / log-level analysis where available.
- Repeated or suspicious traffic patterns.
- Geographic anomalies.
- Conversion-quality analysis.

### SO WHAT?

A destination issue silently caps conversion potential regardless of how efficient targeting is upstream. This is classified P0 — it should be fixed before any other optimization is evaluated for impact.

# Auction Insights, Device & Ad Schedule

Supporting diagnostics reviewed alongside the Search campaign. SOURCE OBSERVATION

## Auction Insights

Reviewed for impression share, overlap rate, position-above rate, top-of-page rate, absolute-top rate, and outranking share to understand competitive visibility.

**Recommendation:** use as a visibility diagnostic — higher competitor visibility alone is not sufficient justification to raise bids.

## Device Performance

Mobile, desktop, and tablet performance were reviewed for CPA, conversion rate, conversion value, and AOV where available.

**Recommendation:** low-volume devices should not be automatically excluded; evaluate against the same sample-size standard used for locations.

## Ad Schedule

Hour-of-day and day-of-week performance were reviewed for CPA, conversion rate, and conversion value.

**Recommendation:** do not restrict all nighttime or off-peak traffic by default; scheduling changes require sufficient data per time segment.

## Quality Score — Diagnostic, Not a Business KPI

Quality Score reflects expected CTR, ad relevance, and landing-page experience.

SOURCE OBSERVATION It is a useful diagnostic for identifying where an ad or landing page is underperforming, but it is not the objective itself. The objective remains profitable conversions, conversion value, CPA, ROAS, and business profitability.

## Recommended Review Cadence

| DIAGNOSTIC         | REVIEW FREQUENCY | TRIGGER FOR ACTION                                                    |
|--------------------|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Auction Insights   | Monthly          | Sustained loss of top-of-page or absolute-top rate.                   |
| Device performance | Bi-weekly        | Sustained CPA divergence at sufficient volume.                        |
| Ad schedule        | Monthly          | Consistent CPA or conversion-rate pattern across 3+ comparable weeks. |
| Quality Score      | Bi-weekly        | Below-average score on a keyword driving meaningful spend.            |

## 02 / OPTIMIZE

# Budget & Scaling Strategy

Efficient growth comes before increased spend.

## Phase 1 — Fix

Resolve the destination issue, correct or replace disapproved assets, and validate conversion tracking end to end.

**Exit criteria:** tracking confirmed accurate; no unresolved technical or policy blockers.

## Phase 2 — Stabilize

Clean search terms and negatives, tier locations and audiences using the frameworks in this audit, and re-baseline CPA once fixes are live.

**Exit criteria:** a stable, trustworthy baseline CPA across Search and Demand Generation for at least 2–4 weeks.

## Phase 3 — Test

Run controlled, budget-capped experiments: AI Max as a Search expansion test, Shopping/Performance Max for e-commerce expansion, and refined Demand Generation audience segments.

**Exit criteria:** each test shows a defined, measurable outcome against its own success criteria.

## Phase 4 — Scale

Increase budget incrementally on validated, efficient segments and campaigns, monitoring for CPA and conversion-quality drift as spend increases.

**Exit criteria:** continuous monitoring shows efficiency holding as budget increases.

## Expansion Framework

- Existing Search:** core demand capture — the current efficiency anchor.
- Shopping / PMax:** e-commerce expansion, introduced after feed and tracking quality are confirmed.

- AI Max:** controlled Search expansion test, not a guaranteed improvement.
- Demand Gen:** upper/mid-funnel demand creation test, evaluated on its own funnel-appropriate metrics.

### SO WHAT?

Each phase has an explicit exit criterion rather than a fixed calendar date. Moving to Phase 2 before Phase 1's tracking and destination fixes are confirmed would mean optimizing decisions on data that cannot yet be trusted — the sequence protects the quality of every decision that follows it.

# 30-Day Optimization Roadmap

A practical, sequenced action plan.

| WEEK 01              | WEEK 02             | WEEK 03                  | WEEK 04              |
|----------------------|---------------------|--------------------------|----------------------|
| <b>Fix</b>           | <b>Clean</b>        | <b>Optimize</b>          | <b>Test</b>          |
| —Tracking validation | —Search-term review | —Ad copy & assets        | —AI Max              |
| —Destination QA      | —Location tiering   | —Landing-page hypotheses | —Shopping / PMax     |
| —Asset corrections   | —Audience tiering   | —Budget rebalancing      | —Demand Gen segments |

## Week 1 — Technical & Tracking Cleanup

1. Confirm the destination issue is resolved and re-test the click-to-purchase path.
2. Correct or replace disapproved logo and asset content.
3. Validate conversion tracking, values, and currency across GA4 and Google Ads.

## Week 2 — Targeting & Traffic Quality

1. Run the weekly search-term workflow and expand negatives.
2. Apply the location tiering framework with a minimum-volume threshold.
3. Apply the audience tiering framework to Demand Generation.
4. Review invalid-traffic signals and click-quality indicators.

## Week 3 — Creative, Assets & Landing Page

1. Refresh ad copy and reconfirm asset approval status.
2. Prioritize and begin testing the highest-confidence CRO hypotheses.
3. Rebalance budget toward validated efficient Search themes.

## Week 4 — Controlled Expansion

1. Launch a budget-capped AI Max test.
2. Evaluate Shopping/PMAX readiness against feed and tracking quality.
3. Refine Demand Generation audience segments based on Weeks 2–3 findings.

# KPI Framework

Quality Score is a diagnostic input, not the primary business KPI.

| KPI              | WHY IT MATTERS                             | DECISION                |
|------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------|
| CPA              | Acquisition efficiency                     | Scale / reduce          |
| ROAS             | Revenue efficiency                         | Budget allocation       |
| Conversion Rate  | Funnel efficiency                          | CRO / traffic quality   |
| Conversion Value | Business value generated                   | Campaign comparison     |
| AOV              | Revenue per order                          | Profitability           |
| CTR              | Ad relevance                               | Creative iteration      |
| CPC              | Traffic cost                               | Bidding efficiency      |
| Impression Share | Competitive visibility                     | Coverage / budget       |
| Quality Score    | Diagnostic (CTR, relevance, LP experience) | Optimization input only |

**SO WHAT?**

Quality Score is included deliberately at the bottom of this table. It informs optimization but should never be reported to stakeholders as a business outcome — CPA, ROAS, and conversion value are the metrics that determine whether spend should increase.

Note: CTR, CPC, conversion rate, ROAS, and AOV figures are not itemized in the source transcript for this account and are therefore not populated with invented numbers in this case study.

DATA NOT AVAILABLE IN SOURCE MATERIAL

# Priority Matrix

What gets fixed first, and why.

| PRIORITY           | ISSUE                                          | BUSINESS IMPACT                                                     | ACTION                                                       |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>P0 Fix Now</b>  | Destination-not-working issue                  | Caps conversion potential regardless of upstream targeting quality. | Resolve and re-test the full click-to-purchase path.         |
| <b>P0 Fix Now</b>  | Unvalidated conversion tracking                | Undermines every downstream optimization decision in this audit.    | Audit and validate tracking, values, and attribution.        |
| <b>P1 Optimize</b> | Demand Gen audience-level CPA spread           | Budget is being spent inefficiently on specific segments.           | Tier audiences; reduce or exclude sustained underperformers. |
| <b>P1 Optimize</b> | Disapproved / low-quality assets               | Reduces ad strength and format eligibility on every impression.     | Correct, replace, or appeal per the remediation process.     |
| <b>P2 Test</b>     | Search-term hygiene and competitor-term policy | Ongoing, lower-magnitude wasted spend.                              | Implement the weekly search-term workflow.                   |
| <b>P2 Test</b>     | Location performance variation                 | Uneven efficiency across Pakistani cities.                          | Apply the location tiering framework with volume thresholds. |
| <b>P3 Explore</b>  | AI Max / Shopping / PMax expansion             | Potential upside, unconfirmed at this account's current maturity.   | Introduce as budget-capped, controlled experiments.          |

## Priority Definitions

**P0 Fix Now**  
Blocks accurate measurement or conversion delivery. Resolve before any other action.

**P3 Explore**  
Future-facing, controlled experiment with unconfirmed upside.

**P1 Optimize**  
Directly affects budget efficiency at current spend levels.

**Sequencing rule:** P0 and P1 items are resolved before any P2 or P3 action begins, regardless of how promising a P3 test appears.

**P2 Test**  
Improves efficiency incrementally; lower urgency than P0/P1.

# FROM DATA → DECISION

## DATA

- CPA
- Conversions
- Locations
- Audiences
- Search terms
- Devices

## DIAGNOSIS

- Inefficient traffic
- Targeting gaps
- Asset issues
- Tracking risks

## DECISION

- Fix
- Reduce
- Test
- Scale

## BUSINESS OUTCOME

- More efficient acquisition
- Better budget allocation
- Stronger measurement
- Controlled growth

## Strategic Recommendation

**Fix → Stabilize → Test → Scale.**

The Search campaign's observed CPA of roughly PKR 160 demonstrates the account can be efficient. The Demand Generation campaign's observed CPA of roughly PKR 1,747 demonstrates that not every part of the account currently is. Aggressive scaling before resolving the destination issue, validating tracking, and tiering audiences and locations would scale inefficiency alongside efficiency — the recommended path is to resolve the P0 and P1 items in the priority matrix first, re-baseline performance, and only then increase budget on validated segments.

### WHY NOT SCALE NOW

A destination issue and unvalidated tracking mean reported performance cannot yet be trusted at higher spend.

### WHY NOT WAIT INDEFINITELY

Search is already demonstrating efficient acquisition — the fix phase is deliberately short and sequenced, not open-ended.

### WHAT CHANGES THE DECISION

A validated baseline held stable for 2–4 weeks is the signal that moves the account from Stabilize into Test.

# What This Audit Demonstrates

This portfolio simulation demonstrates my approach to auditing a Google Ads account — it does not represent client work or personally generated results.

## Diagnosis

- Google Ads account analysis
- Performance diagnosis
- CPA analysis
- Search campaign optimization

## Targeting

- Audience analysis
- Location analysis
- Search-term analysis
- Negative-keyword strategy

## Execution

- Ad asset auditing
- Landing-page / CRO thinking
- Conversion tracking awareness
- Budget allocation & scaling strategy

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The exercise was built around a publicly available Google Ads audit transcript for an e-commerce beauty brand. The analysis applies Google Ads optimization principles — CPA evaluation, audience and location tiering, search-term hygiene, asset remediation, tracking validation, and phased scaling — to demonstrate structured, data-driven decision making. The case study demonstrates how I would approach a real account audit at the start of my Performance Marketing career.

## SO WHAT?

This project is not evidence of prior client results — it is evidence of how I structure a performance problem: separating fact from assumption, prioritizing by business impact, and sequencing fixes before scale.

# FIX THE SIGNAL. THEN SCALE THE SPEND.

## PERFORMANCE MARKETING PRINCIPLE

Efficient growth comes from improving the quality of decisions before increasing the quantity of spend.